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JERUSALEM INTERNATIONAL FELLOWS

Dear <<First Name>>,

We have just experienced the Winter Solstice. Which means the days will be getting longer. There will be MORE LIGHT. As Israelis and Palestinians continue to experience intense trauma and our own country is on the brink of oligarchy, I am looking for reasons for optimism. I asked our former Jerusalem Fellows to share some of their thoughts and plans for 2025:



Anna at the Bloomfield Science Museum in "22, testing out ideas for her sonic weaving project.

Anna Lublina (JIF 2022)

I have a new project called “the land speaks to me of something shared: a prayer for ancestral rhythms” which investigates the political and social histories of rhythms from the Jewish-Muslim world as they encounter colonialism, imperialism, Zionism and other migrations. The work attempts to find these rhythms back in our bodies even if they are almost completely lost. The piece has its origins in my work in Jerusalem about synchronization and asks: what happens if we try to synchronize with the shared worlds of our ancestors? The work will

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premiere in Frankfurt and Berlin in March and April 2025. I am also blessed to continue my work from Bukhara "Bukharan Peace Recipes" at the Bukhara Biennale in fall 2025! The new version will be focused on Sukkot and the hybrid harvest rituals of Bukhara. My work in Bukhara has been asking about the conditions of intercultural societies and what happens when one community (for instance bukhara jews) leaves the mix?



Claudia with Ronen Izhaki, Professor at Jerusalem Academy of Music and Dance whose students came to Mexico as part of an exchange program they created. Hopefully the Mexican students will get to Jerusalem in the near future.

From Claudia Lavista (Fellow 2022):

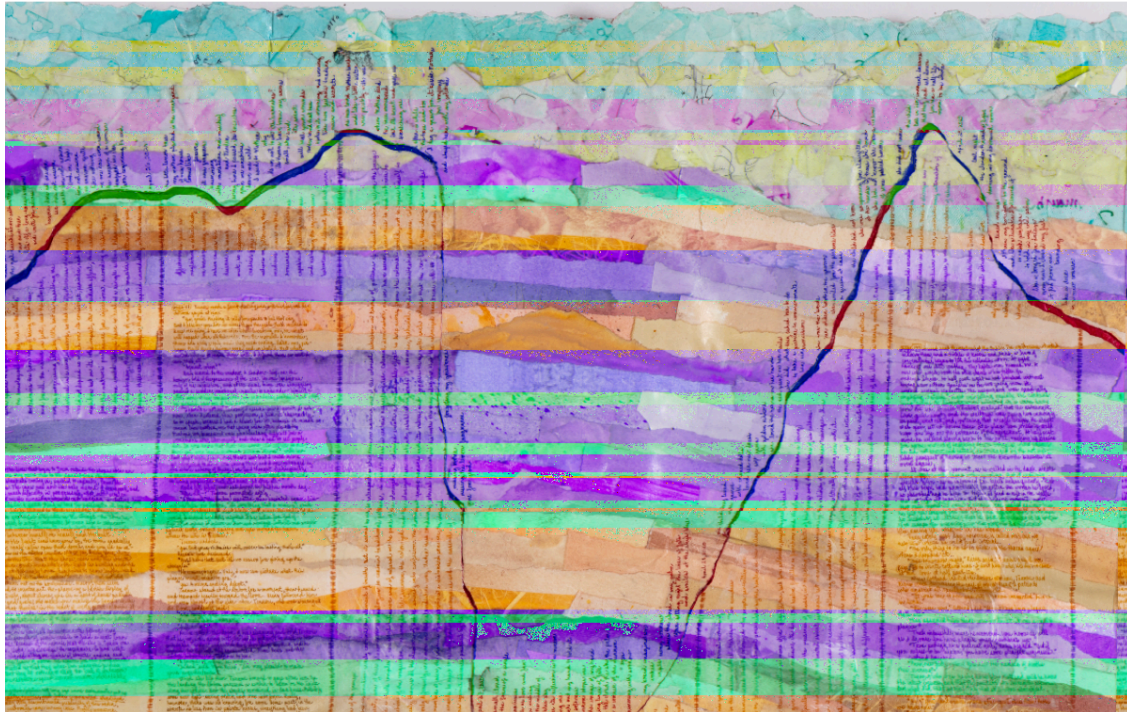
As Director of [Danza UNAM](#) I am overseeing 3 big projects in 2025: "Epicentro"/First Encounter of Universities and Professional Dance Schools in Mexico who will come together for the first time to reflect on pedagogy and relationships as dance makers. "Tradition and Modernity", an encounter with traditional Mexican dance to explore

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new paradigms, narratives and forms of expression. And "SERSUR" Latin American Dance Encounter to give more visibility and reflect around bodies from the Global South and the value and richness of our cultural heritage.



Section of Diane Samuels' work described below.

Diane Samuels (Fellow 2013):

I just completed "[Pandemic: Albert Camus, Frantz Fanon, Rania Mamoun](#)," a public artwork (fabricated by Peters Glasmalerei in Paderborn, Germany) that will be installed in 2025 on the exterior of the Malta Foundation, a new contemporary art museum in Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania. It is a hand-transcription in micro-script of Albert Camus's *The Plague* (1948), an essay *Medicine and Colonialism* from *A Dying Colonialism* (1959) by Frantz Fanon, and poems by Rania Mamoun, a City of Asylum Sudanese author in exile written in 2020 during the pandemic. The work is 7 feet high by 64 feet long.

Lynne Avadenka (Fellow 2011):

I am one of the three co-directors leading a National Endowment for the Humanities Summer Institute taking place next June of 2025.

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"Between Memory and the Archive" is an opportunity to study with amazing faculty, and collaborate with a diverse cohort of colleagues over an intensive two-week period at the YIVO Institute for Jewish Research in New York City and the Cary Graphic Arts Collection at the Rochester Institute of Technology. [Here are the details!](#)

David Herskovitz (Fellow 2011):

My Obie Award-winning [Target Margin Theater](#) will present a reimaging of the seminal musical *Show Boat*, now re-envisioned as *Show/Boat: A River* at NYU's Skirball Center as part of **Under the Radar Festival**. The company's adaptation, which I am directing, reframes the 1927 classic for today's audience, exploring America's transformation from the 1880s Jim Crow to the challenges of today — journeying from steamboats to airplanes, vaudeville to radio, and the Spanish-moss South to the bustling city of Chicago amid the Great Migration.

[Vibha Galhotra](#) (Fellow 2022):

I have one of my works opening at Nirox sculpture park in South Africa in January. I'll be presenting a public work at India Art Fair in February and have a solo show coming up in April in Mumbai.

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Vibha and I will be featured in the Rockefeller Foundation's Bellagio Center Newsletter this spring. We discuss her experience of and work in Jerusalem as well as the impact the Bellagio residency had on each of us. (I was a Fellow there in 2014 figuring out how to restructure the Jerusalem residency as an independent program. Vibha was an artist Fellow there in 2016.) Here's an excerpt from the article:

Art Opening Dialogue:

Vibha contends that in regard to global crises like climate change, division among people only hurts us more. “For me, climate change is the most important issue in the world. It’s something we all need to work on, rather than worrying about our differences,” she said.

Vibha and Elise agree that art can be a powerful tool to drive forward productive conversation about difficult topics. “Generally speaking, I think art is one of the only ways to engage people in constructive dialogue around these issues. Artists are able to get people to communicate,” Elise said.

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Vipha understands the role she plays as an artist engaged in social issues. "Art has a great power to tell stories and bring people into conversation through empathy. If we use it right, we can definitely lead to a better world," she said.

I'm planning a trip to Jerusalem in late January to meet with leaders of past and potential host organizations in East and West Jerusalem. They have all expressed interest in bringing back international artists. I will be there to learn how they envision the program in the coming years and how JIF can meet their needs as they move forward.

I'll close with this thought from **Davidson Norris (Fellow 2013)**:

"As a Fellow my focus was on identifying and documenting what I called Jerusalem's light of place - the red yellow gold light whose gentle warmth and soft radiance sends an every morning message of hope and renewal."

Wishing you and yours a happy holiday and a peaceful, healthy New Year.

- Elise

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